

PU'ER TEA

Often referred to as a post-fermented tea, Pu'er is named after the town in which it is produced in China's Yunnan province. The tea contains microorganisms with probiotic properties, which aid digestion and promote a healthy immune system, so is commonly consumed to aid weight loss. After the leaves are processed, they are steamed and pressed into cakes and aged for several years before they are sold; the tea is also available as loose leaves.

There are two kinds of Pu'er: Sheng (raw), which is allowed to develop and age naturally, and Shou (ripe), which undergoes an accelerated fermentation process. Similar teas are produced in other provinces of China and are referred to as "dark tea" or "hei cha." Post-fermented aged tea, particularly Pu'er, is highly sought-after by connoisseurs who store and age it for decades, as the flavors (which vary from earthy, musty, and leathery, to chocolatey or woody) become more complex over time.



Liu An Dark Tea
Anhui province,
China



Sheng Pu'er Tuo Cha cake
Yunnan province, China

YELLOW TEA

Yellow tea is produced in only a few areas of China, such as the Hunan and Sichuan provinces. As a result, very little is produced or exported, making it fairly rare. As in the case of green tea, the best grades of yellow tea are produced from tea leaves harvested early in spring. Yellow tea is characterized by its fresh and delicate flavor, and gets its name from the leaf's slightly yellow cast, which is caused by the yellowing process it undergoes (see p23).



Jun Shan Yin Zhen
Dong Ting Lake,
Hunan province, China



Mo Gan Huang Ya
Zhejiang province,
China



Meng Ding Huang Ya
Sichuan province, China